

# Word family: \*\*school / schools / schooled / schooling\*\*

\*\*Base word:\*\* school

\*\*Plural:\*\* schools

\*\*Verb forms:\*\* school, schools, schooled, schooling

\*\*Related noun:\*\* schooling

\*\*Part of speech:\*\* noun ( 名詞 ) / verb ( 動詞 )

\*\*Useful constructions/extensions:\*\* school teacher, secondary school, primary school, go to school, at school, leave school, school system, school of thought, school of art, school of fish, school someone, be schooled in, schooling, old-school

Your passage contains:

> “One person who has had a really important influence on my life is my \*\*secondary school English teacher\*\*, Mrs. Chan.”

Here, \*\*school\*\* means:

\*\*an educational institution where students receive formal teaching.\*\*

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## Meaning in this passage

In:

> \*\*secondary school\*\*

\*\*school\*\* refers to:

\*\*an institution providing formal education to students.\*\*

And \*\*secondary school\*\* specifically refers to:

> the educational stage after primary/elementary school and before higher education.

\*\*Meaning:\*\* An institution where children or young people receive formal education.

\*\*繁體中文:\*\* \*\*學校；這裡指中學階段的教育機構\*\*

\*\*中文翻譯:\*\*

> “my secondary school English teacher”

「我的\*\*中學英文老師\*\*」

So:

**\*\*secondary school = 中學 / 中等教育階段的學校\*\***

This is the exact passage meaning.

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# 1. **\*\*school = educational institution ( 學校 ) — 學校 ; 教育機構\*\***

This is the exact core meaning used in your passage.

**\*\*Meaning:\*\*** A place or institution where students receive formal education.

### Practice 1 — Original

> “She was my **\*\*secondary school\*\*** English teacher.”

「她是我的**\*\*中學英文老師\*\***。」

### Practice 2

> “The children walk to **\*\*school\*\*** every morning.”

「孩子們每天早上步行去**\*\*學校\*\***。」

### Practice 3

> “The school has more than a thousand students.”

「這間**\*\*學校\*\***有超過一千名學生。」

**\*\*school = 提供有系統正式教育的機構\*\***

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# 2. **\*\*school = school building/place ( 校舍 / 學校地點 ) — 學校 ; 校舍\*\***

A closely related concrete use.

### Practice 4

> “I left my bag at **\*\*school\*\***.”

「我把袋留在**\*\*學校\*\***了。」

### ### Practice 5

> “The school was closed for repairs.”

「\*\*校舍 / 學校\*\*因維修而關閉。」

\*\*school = 學校實際所在的建築 / 場所\*\*

This remains closely connected to the institution sense and should not be artificially over-split.

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# 3. \*\*go to school ( 上學 ) — 去上學 ; 接受學校教育\*\*

A major grammatical construction.

### ### Practice 6

> “She \*\*goes to school\*\* nearby.”

「她在附近\*\*上學\*\*。」

### ### Practice 7

> “Children usually start going to school at a young age.”

「孩子通常很小便開始\*\*上學\*\*。」

\*\*go to school = 作為學生前往 / 接受學校教育\*\*

Important:

> \*\*go to school\*\*

often focuses on the educational function, not merely physically entering a building.

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# 4. \*\*at school ( 在上學 / 在學校 ) — 在校 ; 上學中\*\*

### ### Practice 8

> “The children are \*\*at school\*\*.”

「孩子們正在\*\*上學 / 在學校\*\*。」

### ### Practice 9

> “I learned French at school.”

「我在\*\*學校\*\*學過法文。」

\*\*at school = 在學校接受教育，或人在學校場所\*\*

Context determines whether the emphasis is institutional or physical.

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# 5. \*\*school = period of formal education ( 求學時期 ) — 學校生活；求學階段\*\*

A major abstract use.

### ### Practice 10

> “I enjoyed \*\*school\*\*.”

「我很享受\*\*學校生活 / 求學時期\*\*。」

### ### Practice 11

> “She was very shy at school.”

「她\*\*上學時\*\*很害羞。」

\*\*school = 一個人接受學校教育的時期 / 經驗，而不是只指建築\*\*

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# 6. \*\*leave school ( 離校 / 畢業 ) — 離開學校教育階段\*\*

### ### Practice 12

> “She \*\*left school\*\* at eighteen.”

「她十八歲時\*\*離開學校 / 完成中學教育\*\*。」

### ### Practice 13

> “What did you do after leaving school?”

「你\*\*離校 / 完成學業後\*\*做了甚麼？」

**\*\*leave school = 結束學校教育，尤其完成或停止中學階段\*\***

This does not simply mean:

> walk out of the school building.

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# 7. **\*\*school = education system ( 學校教育 / 教育制度 ) — 學校教育\*\***

A broader institutional sense.

### Practice 14

> “Children learn many social skills through **\*\*school\*\***.”

「孩子透過**\*\*學校教育\*\***學會很多社交技能。」

### Practice 15

> “The experience changed the way he thought about school.”

「那段經歷改變了他對**\*\*學校教育\*\***的看法。」

**\*\*school = 正規學校教育這套制度 / 經驗\*\***

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# 8. **\*\*school system ( 學校制度 ) — 教育制度\*\***

### Practice 16

> “The **\*\*school system\*\*** differs from country to country.”

「不同國家的**\*\*學校教育制度\*\***不同。」

### Practice 17

> “She has worked in the public school system for years.”

「她在公立**\*\*學校體系\*\***工作多年。」

**\*\*school system = 一個地區 / 國家的學校組織和教育制度\*\***

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# 9. \*\*primary / secondary / high school ( 不同教育階段 ) — 小學 / 中學等\*\*

These are major lexicalized compounds rather than separate bare \*\*school\*\* senses.

#### ### Practice 18

> “She teaches at a \*\*secondary school\*\*.”

「她在一所\*\*中學\*\*任教。」

#### ### Practice 19

> “He moved to a new primary school.”

「他轉到一所新的\*\*小學\*\*。」

\*\*X school = 指特定教育階段 / 類型的學校\*\*

The exact labels vary by educational system and region.

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# 10. \*\*school = particular educational institution/community ( 某一所學校 ) — 校方 / 全校\*\*

A common collective extension.

#### ### Practice 20

> “The whole \*\*school\*\* attended the event.”

「\*\*全校師生\*\*都出席了活動。」

#### ### Practice 21

> “The school supported the charity project.”

「\*\*校方 / 全校\*\*支持這項慈善計劃。」

\*\*school = 代表該校的學生、教師、職員或整個機構\*\*

The context determines whether Chinese is:

\* 學校

\* 校方

\* 全校師生

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# 11. \*\*school = specialized educational institution ( 專門學校 / 學院 ) — 學院 ; 專門學校\*\*

A major extension.

### Practice 22

> “She went to \*\*law school\*\*.”

「她讀了\*\*法律學院\*\*。」

### Practice 23

> “He studied at an art school.”

「他在一所\*\*藝術學校 / 藝術學院\*\*就讀。」

\*\*school = 提供某專門領域教育 / 訓練的機構\*\*

Common examples:

- \* law school
- \* medical school
- \* business school
- \* art school
- \* drama school

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# 12. \*\*school = faculty/division within a university ( 大學學院 / 學系單位 ) — 學院\*\*

A common higher-education use.

### Practice 24

> “She works in the \*\*School of Education\*\*.”

「她在\*\*教育學院\*\*工作。」

### Practice 25

> “The university has a School of Engineering.”

「這所大學設有\*\*工程學院\*\*。」

**\*\*School of X = 大學內某個大型學術 / 行政單位\*\***

This use depends on institutional naming.

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# 13. **\*\*school = school of thought ( 思想流派 ) — 學派 ; 思想流派\*\***

A major genuinely distinct sense.

**\*\*Meaning:\*\*** A group of people sharing similar ideas, theories, or methods.

### Practice 26

> “There are several **\*\*schools of thought\*\*** on the issue.”

「對這個問題存在幾個不同的**\*\*思想流派 / 學派\*\***。」

### Practice 27

> “She belongs to a different school of thought.”

「她屬於另一個**\*\*思想學派\*\***。」

**\*\*school of thought = 一群持有共同理論、觀點或分析方法的人\*\***

This is not an educational institution.

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# 14. **\*\*school = artistic/intellectual tradition ( 藝術 / 學術流派 ) — 流派 ; 學派\*\***

### Practice 28

> “The painting belongs to the Dutch **\*\*school\*\***.”

「這幅畫屬於荷蘭**\*\*畫派\*\***。」

### Practice 29

> “The philosopher influenced a whole school of thinkers.”

「這位哲學家影響了整個**\*\*思想學派\*\***。」

**\*\*school = 具有共同風格、方法或理論傳統的一群創作者 / 思想家\*\***

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# 15. **\*\*school of painting/art ( 畫派 / 藝術流派 ) — 畫派；藝術流派\*\***

#### Practice 30

> “The artist was associated with a modern **\*\*school of painting\*\***.”

「這位藝術家與一個現代**\*\*畫派\*\***有關。」

#### Practice 31

> “Different schools of art developed in the region.”

「該地區發展出不同的藝術**\*\*流派\*\***。」

**\*\*school = 共享特定風格、技巧或理念的藝術家群體\*\***

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# 16. **\*\*school = group of fish ( 魚群 ) — 魚群\*\***

A completely separate noun meaning.

**\*\*Meaning:\*\*** A large group of fish swimming together.

#### Practice 32

> “A **\*\*school of fish\*\*** swam past the boat.”

「一**\*\*群魚\*\***游過船旁。」

#### Practice 33

> “We saw a huge school of silver fish.”

「我們看到一大**\*\*群銀色的魚\*\***。」

**\*\*a school of fish = 一群一起游動的魚\*\***

This is a genuine homonymous/polysemous noun use that learners should know.

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# 17. **\*\*school = verb: educate formally ( 教育；教導 ) — 教育；培養\*\***

Now **school** is a verb.

**Meaning:** To educate or train someone systematically.

#### ### Practice 34

> “The children were **schooled at home**.”

「那些孩子在家中**接受教育**。」

#### ### Practice 35

> “She was schooled in several languages.”

「她從小**接受過多種語言的教育 / 訓練**。」

**school someone** = 對某人進行有系統的教育 / 訓練

Somewhat more formal than:

> teach.

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# 18. **be schooled in something** ( 受過.....訓練 / 教育 ) — 精通 ; 受訓於

A major construction.

#### ### Practice 36

> “He was **schooled in classical music**.”

「他受過**古典音樂訓練**。」

#### ### Practice 37

> “She was well schooled in public speaking.”

「她在公開演講方面受過良好的**訓練**。」

**be schooled in X** = 在某個知識、技能或傳統方面受過系統訓練

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# 19. **school** = train/discipline someone's behaviour ( 訓練 / 控制 ) — 訓練 ; 克制

A figurative verb extension.

#### ### Practice 38

> “He \*\*schooled himself to remain calm\*\*.”

「他訓練自己\*\*保持冷靜\*\*。」

#### ### Practice 39

> “She schooled her expression into neutrality.”

「她努力\*\*控制自己的表情\*\*，讓它顯得平靜中立。」

\*\*school yourself = 透過自我訓練控制情緒、反應或行為\*\*

More formal/literary.

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# 20. \*\*school someone = teach someone a lesson / outperform them ( 教訓 / 狠狠示範 ) — 給某人上了一課\*\*

An informal modern use.

#### ### Practice 40

> “The experienced player \*\*schooled\*\* the younger opponent.”

「那位有經驗的球員狠狠地\*\*給年輕對手上了一課\*\*。」

#### ### Practice 41

> “She schooled everyone in the debate.”

「她在辯論中完全\*\*壓倒其他人 / 給大家示範了甚麼叫高水平\*\*。」

\*\*school someone = 非正式地以高超表現教訓 / 壓倒某人，顯示對方還有很多要學\*\*

Informal, especially in sport/gaming/conversation.

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# 21. \*\*schooling = formal education ( 學校教育 ) — 正規教育；受教育程度\*\*

A major related noun.

#### ### Practice 42

> “She received most of her **\*\*schooling\*\*** abroad.”

「她大部分的**\*\*學校教育\*\***都在海外接受。」

#### ### Practice 43

> “He had very little formal schooling.”

「他接受的**\*\*正規學校教育\*\***很少。」

**\*\*schooling** = 一個人所接受的正規學校教育 / 教育過程

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# 22. **\*\*schooling** = training/education in a skill ( 訓練 ) — 培訓 ; 教導

#### ### Practice 44

> “Years of musical **\*\*schooling\*\*** shaped her style.”

「多年的音樂**\*\*訓練\*\***塑造了她的風格。」

#### ### Practice 45

> “His early schooling in design influenced his career.”

「他早期在設計方面接受的**\*\*訓練 / 教育\*\***影響了他的事業。」

**\*\*schooling** = 在某領域接受系統教育 / 訓練的過程

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# 23. **\*\*old-school** ( 老派的 / 傳統的 ) — 傳統 ; 老派

A major modern compound.

#### ### Practice 46

> “He has an **\*\*old-school\*\*** approach to teaching.”

「他的教學方式比較**\*\*傳統 / 老派\*\***。」

#### ### Practice 47

> “She prefers old-school notebooks to digital apps.”

「比起數碼應用程式，她更喜歡\*\*傳統式的\*\*筆記本。」

\*\*old-school = 採用較傳統、舊式的方法、風格或價值觀\*\*

Depending on tone, it can be:

\* positive: classic/traditional;

\* negative: outdated.

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# 24. \*\*old school ( 傳統派的人 / 風格 ) — 老派；傳統作風\*\*

#### ### Practice 48

> “He’s very \*\*old school\*\*.”

「他這個人很\*\*老派 / 傳統\*\*。」

#### ### Practice 49

> “Their management style is old school.”

「他們的管理方式很\*\*傳統\*\*。」

\*\*be old school = 偏好 / 遵循較傳統的做法或價值\*\*

Informal.

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# 25. \*\*school-age ( 學齡的 ) — 學齡兒童的\*\*

A common compound.

#### ### Practice 50

> “The programme is designed for \*\*school-age children\*\*.”

「這個計劃是為\*\*學齡兒童\*\*而設。」

#### ### Practice 51

> “There are several school-age children in the family.”

「這個家庭有幾個\*\*學齡孩子\*\*。」

\*\*school-age = 年齡已達一般正式上學階段的\*\*

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# 26. \*\*school day ( 上學日 / 學校一天 ) — 上課日 ; 學校生活的一天\*\*

### Practice 52

> “A typical \*\*school day\*\* begins at eight.”

「一般\*\*上課日\*\*八點開始。」

### Practice 53

> “She remembered her school days fondly.”

「她很懷念自己的\*\*學生時代 / 求學日子\*\*。」

\*\*school day(s) = 正式上課的一天 ; 複數亦可指學生時代\*\*

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# 27. \*\*schoolwork ( 學校功課 ) — 課業 ; 功課\*\*

A useful lexicalized compound.

### Practice 54

> “She spends an hour on \*\*schoolwork\*\* every evening.”

「她每天晚上花一小時做\*\*課業 / 功課\*\*。」

### Practice 55

> “He was struggling with his schoolwork.”

「他的\*\*課業\*\*有點跟不上。」

\*\*schoolwork = 學生因學校教育而需要完成的學習 / 功課\*\*

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# 28. \*\*schoolteacher / school teacher ( 學校老師 ) — 教師\*\*

### ### Practice 56

> “Her mother was a \*\*schoolteacher\*\*.”

「她的母親是一名\*\*學校教師\*\*。」

### ### Practice 57

> “He worked as a school teacher for thirty years.”

「他當了三十年的\*\*教師\*\*。」

\*\*schoolteacher = 在學校任教的老師\*\*

In ordinary modern English:

> teacher

is often enough when context is clear.

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## Important distinction: \*\*school vs class\*\*

This is one of the most important learner contrasts.

### \*\*school\*\*

= institution/system/place of education.

### \*\*class\*\*

can mean:

- \* lesson session;
- \* group of students;
- \* course grouping.

Compare:

> “I went to school.”

= 我去上學。

> “I went to class.”

= 我去上課。

You can be at school but not currently in class.

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## Important distinction: **school vs university**

### **school**

can broadly mean an educational institution.

But in British/international everyday English:

> **school**

usually refers especially to education before university.

In American English:

> “school”

can more broadly include university/college:

> “I’m still in school.”

So regional context matters.

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## Important distinction: **secondary school vs high school**

These overlap, but educational systems differ.

### **secondary school**

= broad term for education after primary school.

### **high school**

= common term in systems such as the U.S. and others, usually referring to particular later secondary years.

They should not always be mechanically treated as identical across countries.

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## Important distinction: **school vs education**

### **school**

= institution/system/experience providing formal education.

### **education**

= much broader process of learning and development.

A person can receive education:

- \* at school;
- \* at home;
- \* through experience;
- \* independently.

So:

> school is one context for education.

---

## Important distinction: **school vs schooling**

### **school**

can mean the institution or education system.

### **schooling**

focuses on:

> the formal education someone receives.

> “Her schooling was interrupted.”

means:

> her education process was interrupted.

Not that the physical school was interrupted.

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## Important distinction: \*\*go to school vs go to the school\*\*

This is crucial.

### \*\*go to school\*\*

= go there as part of being a student / attend school.

### \*\*go to the school\*\*

= go to a particular school building, perhaps for any purpose.

Compare:

> “The child went to school.”

= 孩子去上學。

> “The parent went to the school to meet the teacher.”

= 家長去了那間學校。

The article changes the emphasis.

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## Important distinction: \*\*at school vs at the school\*\*

### \*\*at school\*\*

= attending/being at school in the student/institutional sense.

### \*\*at the school\*\*

= physically at a particular school location.

Same institutional/physical distinction.

---

## Important distinction: \*\*leave school vs leave the school\*\*

### \*\*leave school\*\*

= finish/stop formal school education.

### \*\*leave the school\*\*

= physically depart from the school building or stop belonging to that specific institution.

Compare:

> “She left school at eighteen.”

= 完成 / 停止學校教育。

> “She left the school at four o’clock.”

= 四點離開那間學校。

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## Important distinction: \*\*school = institution vs school = people\*\*

Compare:

> “The school was built in 1960.”

= institution/building.

> “The whole school cheered.”

= students/staff collectively.

Same noun, different referent.

---

## Important distinction: \*\*school of thought vs school building\*\*

### \*\*school of thought\*\*

= group sharing ideas/theory.

There is no literal school building required.

So:

> “two schools of thought”

means:

> two competing intellectual approaches,

not two educational institutions.

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## Important distinction: **\*\*school of art vs art school\*\***

The word order changes meaning.

### **\*\*art school\*\***

= educational institution teaching art.

### **\*\*school of art\*\***

can mean:

\* an institutional department;

\* an artistic tradition/style.

Context decides.

Very important.

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## Important distinction: **\*\*school of fish vs group of fish\*\***

### **\*\*school of fish\*\***

= established collective noun, often implying fish moving together.

### **\*\*group of fish\*\***

= generic description.

**\*\*School\*\*** here is lexicalized and unrelated to education in modern meaning.

---

## Important distinction: **\*\*school vs teach\*\***

### \*\*teach\*\*

= give instruction/knowledge.

### \*\*school\*\*

as a verb = educate/train systematically, often more formal.

> "She taught me English."

normal.

> "She schooled me in classical literature."

more formal, emphasizing training.

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## Important distinction: \*\*school someone vs educate someone\*\*

### \*\*educate\*\*

= broadly provide education/develop knowledge.

### \*\*school\*\*

= systematically train/educate, sometimes in a particular discipline.

> schooled in diplomacy

can also suggest disciplined training in behaviour.

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## Important distinction: \*\*school yourself vs control yourself\*\*

### \*\*control yourself\*\*

= restrain a reaction in the moment.

### \*\*school yourself to do something\*\*

= deliberately train yourself over time to react/behave in a particular way.

The second emphasizes discipline and learned control.

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## Important distinction: \*\*school someone informal vs teach someone\*\*

Compare:

> “She taught him tennis.”

= genuinely instructed him.

But:

> “She schooled him on the tennis court.”

informally means:

> she comprehensively outperformed him / showed him how much he had to learn.

Tone changes dramatically.

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## Important distinction: \*\*schooling vs training\*\*

### \*\*schooling\*\*

= education, especially formal and academic.

### \*\*training\*\*

= development of a specific skill/ability.

They can overlap in:

> musical schooling/training,

but \*\*schooling\*\* often sounds broader/more educational.

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## Important distinction: \*\*old-school vs old school\*\*

Both forms occur depending grammar.

### Before a noun:

> **old-school values**

usually hyphenated.

### Predicative:

> “He is **old school**.”

usually no hyphen.

Meaning remains:

> traditional / conventional / from an earlier style.

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## Important distinction: **old-school vs outdated**

### **old-school**

can be affectionate/positive:

> traditional, classic, reliable.

### **outdated**

is generally negative:

> no longer suitable/current.

So old-school does not automatically mean bad.

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## Family-extension sweep

The practical **school** family is rich across education, intellectual traditions, collective nouns, and verbal training:

\* **school — educational institution** = 學校

\* **school — building/place** = 校舍 / 學校場所

\* **go to school** = 上學

\* **at school** = 在校 / 上學中

\* **school — period of education** = 求學時期 / 學校生活

\* **leave school** = 完成 / 停止學校教育

\* **school — education system** = 學校教育 / 教育體制

\* \*\*school system\*\* = 學校教育制度  
 \* \*\*primary school\*\* = 小學  
 \* \*\*secondary school\*\* = 中學  
 \* \*\*school — community\*\* = 校方 / 全校師生  
 \* \*\*law/medical/business/art school\*\* = 專門學院 / 學校  
 \* \*\*School of X\*\* = 大學內某學術單位  
 \* \*\*school of thought\*\* = 思想學派  
 \* \*\*school of art\*\* = 藝術流派 / 畫派  
 \* \*\*school of fish\*\* = 魚群  
 \* \*\*school — verb: educate\*\* = 教育 / 訓練  
 \* \*\*be schooled in\*\* = 受過某方面訓練  
 \* \*\*school yourself\*\* = 訓練自己控制 / 養成某種反應  
 \* \*\*school someone — informal\*\* = 給某人上了一課 / 徹底壓倒  
 \* \*\*schooling\*\* = 正規教育 / 受教育過程  
 \* \*\*old-school\*\* = 傳統 / 老派  
 \* \*\*school-age\*\* = 學齡的  
 \* \*\*school day(s)\*\* = 上課日 / 學生時代  
 \* \*\*schoolwork\*\* = 課業  
 \* \*\*schoolteacher\*\* = 學校教師

The main semantic branches are:

- > \*\*educational institution/place\*\*
- > \*\*formal education and school experience\*\*
- > \*\*specialized academic institution\*\*
- > \*\*intellectual/artistic tradition\*\*
- > \*\*group of fish\*\*
- > \*\*verb: educate, train, discipline\*\*

plus useful lexicalized compounds such as:

- > \*\*old-school / schoolwork / school-age\*\*

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## ## Master comparison

| Form / sense                | MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning |  |
|-----------------------------|---------------------------------------|--|
| -----                       | -----                                 |  |
| **school — institution**    | 提供有系統正式教育的機構 / 學校                     |  |
| **school — building/place** | 學校實際所在的建築或場所                          |  |

|                                |                         |  |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------|--|
| **go to school**               | 作為學生前往 / 接受正式學校教育；上學    |  |
| **at school**                  | 在學校接受教育，或人在學校場所         |  |
| **school — period/experience** | 一個人接受學校教育的時期 / 學校生活     |  |
| **leave school**               | 結束或停止學校教育，尤其完成 / 離開中學階段 |  |
| **school — education system**  | 正規學校教育這套制度 / 體系         |  |
| **school — community**         | 某校的學生、教師、職員或整個校方        |  |
| **specialized school**         | 提供某一專業領域教育 / 訓練的機構      |  |
| **School of X**                | 大學內某個大型學術 / 行政單位        |  |
| **school of thought**          | 共享相似理論、觀點或方法的一群思想家 / 學者 |  |
| **school of art**              | 共享特定藝術風格、技巧或理念的創作者群體    |  |
| **school of fish**             | 一大群一起游動的魚               |  |
| **school — verb: educate**     | 對某人進行系統教育 / 訓練          |  |
| **be schooled in X**           | 在某知識、技能或傳統方面受過有系統訓練     |  |
| **school yourself**            | 透過自我訓練控制情緒、反應或行為        |  |
| **school someone — informal**  | 以明顯較高水平壓倒某人、令其「上了一課」    |  |
| **schooling**                  | 一個人接受的正式學校教育 / 系統訓練     |  |
| **old-school**                 | 採用較傳統、舊式的方式、價值或風格       |  |
| **school-age**                 | 已達一般接受正式學校教育的年齡         |  |
| **schoolwork**                 | 因學校學習而需要完成的課業 / 功課      |  |

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## For your original passage

> “One person who has had a really important influence on my life is my \*\*secondary school English teacher\*\*, Mrs. Chan.”

The exact meaning is:

**\*\*school = an institution providing formal education\*\***

and:

**\*\*secondary school = the stage of formal education after primary school and before higher education\*\***

Therefore:

> **\*\*secondary school English teacher\*\***

= **\*\*「中學英文老師」\*\***

The most important learner contrast here is:

> **\*\*secondary school\*\***

versus:

> **\*\*school of thought\*\***

versus:

> **\*\*school of fish\*\***

The same noun can refer to three radically different things:

> **\*\*a place/system of education\*\***

> **\*\*a group sharing ideas/style\*\***

> **\*\*a group of fish\*\***

The most important learner contrasts are:

> **\*\*go to school\*\***

> = 上學

> **\*\*go to the school\*\***

> = 去那間學校 / 校舍

> **\*\*leave school\*\***

> = 完成 / 停止學校教育

> **\*\*leave the school\*\***

> = 離開那所學校 / 退出該校

> **\*\*secondary school\*\***

> = 中學

> **\*\*law school\*\***

> = 法學院

> **\*\*school of thought\*\***

> = 思想學派

> **\*\*school of painting\*\***

> = 畫派

> **\*\*a school of fish\*\***

> = 一群魚

> **\*\*be schooled in music\*\***

> = 受過音樂訓練

> \*\*school yourself to stay calm\*\*

> = 訓練自己保持冷靜

> \*\*school an opponent\*\*

> = 給對手上了一課 / 徹底壓倒 ( 非正式 )

> \*\*schooling\*\*

> = 正規教育 / 受教育過程

> \*\*old-school\*\*

> = 老派 / 傳統

So \*\*school\*\* is much richer than simply:

> \*\*school = 學校\*\*

The key semantic map is:

**SCHOOL — education**

→ institution

→ school experience/system

→ specialized educational institution

**SCHOOL — intellectual/artistic grouping**

→ school of thought/style

**SCHOOL — animal collective**

→ group of fish

**SCHOOL — verb**

→ educate/train

→ discipline oneself

→ informally outperform and “teach someone a lesson”

And in your original passage:

**school = “the formal educational institution/stage where Mrs. Chan taught you English.”**